

comes on the right side and the back on the left. Once it is ready, delete the vertical guide and print the card on two sides of the same page. Fold it down the middle and your card is ready to send.

There are also hundreds of software available to make greeting cards. There are two ways in which they work—they let you create your card with the normal front, back and inside views for printing (the software takes care of the orientation of the card when printing) or they create cards that you can send by e-mail. These are normally self-executable so that the recipient doesn't need to install any software to view them. FreeCard (www.pcwww.com), and Talking Greeting Maker (www.4dev.com) are some free software for making cards. Greetings! (www.eplumsystem.com) is a plug-in for Word that allows you to easily create cards from Word itself without the manual process.

Unlike ICQ, MSN doesn't automatically save a history of my chat messages. Is there any way to log my chat sessions in MSN?

MSN Messenger has one major shortcoming—by default it does not save the chat messages. You can use an add-on called Messenger Plus to log all your chat sessions automatically, so that you can dig them up later for future reference. Alternatively, you can use a unified messaging software such as Trillian

(www.trillian.cc). Trillian allows you to chat over several messaging services (Hotmail, Yahoo!, ICQ, AOL and IRC), and also logs chat sessions for each of them and has many additional features such as skins, custom Away messages, etc that are present in some IMs.

How can I have my PC keep track of birthdays?

Keeping track of birthdays is as simple as using a reminder or scheduler program. If you already use Outlook, you can set up each birthday as a task with the appropriate date and configure it to be recurring every year. You can set up an alert for it as per your convenience. Thus, the birthdays and anniversaries



Use recurring tasks in Outlook for birthday reminders

can actually be planned among your other tasks, making this a very useful solution. If you don't use Outlook, you can still use any other free utility to remind you of special occasions. Free tools such as Birthday Reminder (www.harshal.da.ru) manage birthdays and anniversaries quite well.

I have so many books and my friends often borrow them. Keeping a track is too taxing.

There are several software to help you set up a library at

home. Book Librarian (www.turbosystems.com/winprod.htm) can organise and manage your library, track borrowers and due dates. Book Organizer Deluxe



Set up your own electronic library

(www.primasoft.com) has powerful searching, reporting and labelling capabilities. You can even associate scanned images with the books.

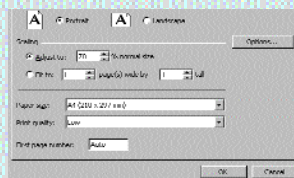
The cartridges for my printer cost too much. I wonder why they run out so fast.

Printing can be quite expensive depending on the kind of printer you have, the number of pages you print and also the print settings. You can't really do much about the first one unless you are buying a new printer. You can reduce the number of pages you print in several simple ways. If you print from Office applications, you can reduce the number of pages used from within the software. Word, by default, uses large page margins that you often don't need. Reduce the margin size to use a larger area of the page for printing. Word also has a built-in function to reduce the page count. Go to the Print Preview mode and click on the Shrink to Fit icon on the toolbar. Word will try to fit the document on one page lesser

than the current count using automatic calculations. In Excel, you can set the zoom percentage at which a sheet is printed. Lowering this value can reduce wastage drastically. PowerPoint, too, allows you to print multiple slides per page.

There are some software such as FinePrint (www.single-track.com), that let you print multiple pages on a single sheet from any application. FinePrint installs itself as a printer driver, so you just need to print to this virtual printer and enter the number of pages that should be printed per sheet. You can preview the layout and print from here to your printer. Each page is resized to the defined area and formatted accordingly. This is excellent when you want to just read the content and don't need a final proof.

Print settings can contribute quite a bit to printing expenses. If you don't need great quality prints, print in Draft or Economy mode. This reduces the amount of ink used and increases cartridge



Reduce the zoom percentage at which Excel sheets are printed

life. Also, if you don't need colour, print in greyscale—colour cartridges cost more than black ones. Set these as default settings by clicking **Start > Settings > Printers** and



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